tap on '*Cached data*'. Then, click OK. If you don't want to do this manually, download *CCleaner*, it cleans out app cache periodically, as needed.

You can also go one step further and wipe your device's cache partition as well. The cache partition is not to be confused with app cached data. It contains temporary system files and you will have to boot your phone into recovery mode to wipe it. First, just enter recovery mode on your device. The method of entering recovery varies from device to device, you can simply Google how to do it for your particular phone. Once you're in recovery mode, use the volume keys to navigate and the power button to select. Navigate down to 'wipe cache partition' and select it.

Update everything

The latest system update will usually be the most stable version you can be on. It often contains bug fixes and general improvements for your system to run better. It is generally not a good idea to put off OS updates unless you specifically see reviews complaining of the update slowing the device down. If this isn't the case, update your OS as soon as it's available. Software updates generally come OTA (over the air) and most phones should prompt you to install them. However, you can always check to see if you've missed one by heading over to *Settings > About device > Software update*. For iOS, go to *Settings > General > Software update* to install iOS updates.

The same logic applies to apps, so ensure that all the apps you have on your phone are updated to their latest version. Just head over to the Play Store or App Store to update your apps. Old versions of apps are usually more buggy and less optimised, so updating them can keep your device running more smoothly.

Scale back animations on Android

Scaling back the animation speeds can make your phone feel significantly snappier. Just open up *Settings* and tap '*System*'. Now head to '*About Phone*' (in some phones this option may be in a different spot). Tap on '*Build Number*' seven times and now hit the back button. You will find a new menu dubbed '*Developer Options*'. Scroll down to the section labelled '*Drawing*' and now you will see three animation-related settings – *Window animation scale, Transition animation scale,* and *Animator duration scale*. Change all three values to '*Animation scale .5x*'. You will notice that most actions are more snappy now. You can even choose to turn the animation off altogether.

LAPTOPS/PCS

Clear unnecessary files and software

If you start running out of space on your laptop or computer, you'll most likely begin to experience performance issues. If you've wiped most of the large files on your PC and don't know exactly what is taking up space, you can use a feature called '*Storage Sense*' on Windows that can help clear unnecessary files. There's also third-party options such as *CCleaner*. On Mac, you can use Apple's built-in storage tool tucked behind '*About This Mac*'. You also have third-party options such as *DaisyDisk* or *CleanMyMacX* to help declutter your system. It is also a good idea to install software that you rarely use. On Windows, select *Control Panel* and then uninstall any program and on Mac, simply drag the software to the Trash icon and then empty your Trash folder.

Defragment your hard drives

When files are saved on your hard disk, small packets of data get saved in random places on the drive. Since they're spread out, the PC can take longer to gather this data and open the file. Defragging hard drives brings these data packets closer together, thus opening files quicker. Windows automatically defrags hard drives once a week but if you notice files are taking longer to open, you can manually do this. In the Windows search bar, type Defrag and open '*Defragment and Optimize Drives*'. Select your hard drive and press analyse. You can now see how fragmented the drive is. If it is anything above 10 per cent, click on '*Optimize*'.

Replacing your HDD with an SSD can help boost performance

Macs prevent fragmentation, so this is not applicable for them. Note: It is advised not to defragment too often, only do it when you notice a severe dip in performance.

Replace your hard drive with an SSD

If you own an older machine that feels sluggish, and you have a hard drive, it may be time to ditch it. These types of drives usually pale in comparison to modern SSDs when it comes to performance. If you notice that your PC is taking too long to boot or for apps to open, your hard drive may be causing this slowdown. Switching out your hard drive with an SSD will most likely give you a pretty significant boost in overall performance.

Upgrade your RAM

Your system's RAM allows it to run multiple programs at once. So, the more RAM you have, the more you can multitask. If you are using a machine that allows you to upgrade the RAM (some thin-and-light laptops don't allow this), then chances are doing this will improve overall performance, especially in regards to multitasking. Try to double your RAM if possible (8 GB to 16 GB, 4 GB to 8 GB) or increase it in lower increments, either way you should definitely have a smoother overall experience.

Reapply thermal paste

Thermal paste can wear out over the years, causing overheating and thermal throttling (slowdown due to overheating). If you haven't replaced the thermal paste in a long time, or have never done so, then find a reliable tutorial to DIY this, or you can get professional help. d